Quickstart Guide

Transcribing the England and Wales Census

FreeCEN2

Version 1 - October 2020

This Quickstart Guide provides an overview of Transcribing for FreeCEN2. It is intended for use by experienced Transcribers and does not replace the FreeCEN Handbook. The Handbook is far more detailed and contains images. This Guide is meant as a quick reference only. If you have a problem, consult the Handbook.

Accessing CSVProc

To access CSVProc you will need to sign into your FreeCEN account.

To do this, go to https://www.FreeCEN.org.uk/ . Above the 'Search Our Census Records' form you will see a menu which includes 'Member'.

1. Click on 'Member' and it will take you to a sign in form.
2. If you have previously logged in and ticked the 'Keep me logged in box' you will not see 'Member' as a menu item. It will have been replaced with 'Your Actions'. In that case skip step 3 and go straight to step 4.
3. Enter your Userid or email and your Password. If you do not want to sign in every time, put a tick in the 'Keep me logged in' box.
4. You will now be taken to the 'Your Actions' screen.

Downloading a Blank Spreadsheet

1. Select CSV Batches.
2. Select Download Spreadsheet.

You will be presented with a list of available spreadsheets.

3. Click on the spreadsheet that you need. It will download to your computer.

You will probably see a downloaded file at the bottom of your screen.

4. Click on this and select Open and your blank spreadsheet will open on your screen.
5. Save it with the name of your new piece using the Spreadsheet Naming guidelines.

Spreadsheet Naming

The spreadsheet used as an input for CSVProc will have a two-part or three-part name.

- The first part will be the National Archives year identifier (e.g. HO107 or RG9 or RG10).
- The second part will be the piece number. This will be preceded by an underscore (_). Please be aware that the "number is NOT an integer but the "number" assigned by the National Archives. It CAN be an alphanumeric e.g. 2345A. The Scottish suffices will be included in the number.

- The last part is optional. If used it will be a single letter preceded by an underscore (_). This is only used when a large piece is broken into smaller parts by the Coordinator and each part can be individually transcribed, proofread, validated and published. In that case the Coordinator will allocate the suffix to each part of the piece. The smallest unit that a Piece can be broken into is an Enumeration District (ED). If an ED is broken into smaller units it will create an Error when it is Published.

The file name will therefore look like this:
HO107_123.csv or HO107_1234_a.csv or RG9_2345.csv or RG10_2370_a.csv.

Column (Field) Types

Valid field types are:

- **Number** – Containing only the numbers 0 to 9 (e.g. 29).
- **Number and Suffix** - Containing only the numbers 0 to 9 followed by a letter (e.g. 29a).
- **Special Entry** – These will be defined for each relevant field in the field profile. CSVProc will test the field for the correct entry or pattern.
- **Narrow Text** – Narrow Text permits any word character (letter, number, underscore) plus **, '**
- **Broad Text** - Broad Text permits any word character (letter, number, underscore) plus **- ( ) . , & '**

Do not use the / character or ? in a text field apart from the Notes field.

Field Transcription Rules

For the FreeCEN2 database to be fully searchable we all need to record the census information in the same way. Use the following guidelines to provide consistency.

If you find that entering (only) a hyphen in a cell does not work as expected, try using a Tab or Enter after the - . The entry of **'-** (single-quote hyphen) will create an Error in some fields. This is because '- is two characters and some fields are set to accept only one character, or because CSVProc is looking for – and '- does not match.

Whilst you are transcribing there will be occasions when you cannot read letters or words to transcribe them. In that case enter an underscore (_) or a series of underscores to indicate where the problem is. You will also need to set the appropriate query flag.

If you are transcribing Shipping Returns use the shipping guidelines in the Handbook.

Enumeration District (ED) Information

If any change is made in one of the fields in this Section (except the location flag) then all of the fields in the ED section must be re-entered. If this is not done CSVProc will report Errors.

Field name	**enumeration_district**
Column Contains	ED Number
Year/s Used	1841 - 1911
What Can Be Entered	Number or number and suffix or special entry

Description and Rules Only enter the ED number once until it changes. If there is no identifiable ED number, then use 0 (zero).If the content of any of the fields in this section changes it will also need to be re-entered.

Special Categories - Use one of the following numbers as the relevant suffix:

1. Barracks & Military Quarters
2. HM Ships, at Home
3. Workhouses & Pauper Schools
4. Hospitals (Sick, Convalescent, Incurables)
5. Lunatic Asylums
6. Prisons
7. Certified Reformatory & Industrial Schools
8. Merchant Vessels & Lighthouses
9. Schools

Field name	**civil_parish**
Column Contains	Civil Parish
Year/s Used	All censuses
What Can Be Entered	Narrow Text

Description and Rules Only enter it once at the beginning of an ED until it changes. If the content of any of the fields in this section changes it will also need to be re-entered. A blank or – (hyphen) is not an acceptable entry.

Field name **ecclesiastical_parish**

Column Contains Ecclesiastical Parish

Year/s Used 1851 – 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text

Description and Rules Only enter this information once at the beginning of the ED unless it changes. If the content of any of the fields in this section changes it will also need to be re-entered. If nothing is entered enter a – (hyphen) at the start of each ED. The Ecclesiastical Parish is not recorded in the 1841 census.

Field name **where_census_taken**

Column Contains Where Census Taken

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text

Description and Rules The place where the census was taken can be the name of the Island, Borough or Burgh, Municipal Borough, City, Town, Village, Hamlet or Tything. There are various options for the enumerator to record this information but only one was usually used for each place that the census was taken, depending on the circumstances. In 1841 it may have been recorded as a County Corporate. If more than one option is provided enter only the smallest in size. Only enter this information once at the beginning of the ED unless it changes. If the content of any of the fields in this section changes it will also need to be re-entered. A blank or – (hyphen) is not an acceptable entry.

Field name **ward**

Column Contains Ward

Year/s Used 1861 – 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text

Description and Rules If nothing is entered, enter a – (hyphen) at the start of each ED. Only enter this information once at the beginning of the ED unless it changes. If the content of any of the fields in this section changes it will also need to be re-entered. In 1861 the information was often blank.

Field name **parliamentary_constituency**

Column Contains Parliamentary Constituency

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text

Description and Rules Only enter this information once at the beginning of the ED unless it changes. If the content of any of the fields in this section changes it will also need to be re-entered. The information may have been recorded as Parliamentary District. It was often left blank in the earlier censuses. In this case enter a – (hyphen) at the start of each ED.

Field name **sanitary_district**

Column Contains Sanitary District

Year/s Used 1871 – 1891

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text

Description and Rules Only enter this information once at the beginning of the ED unless it changes. If the content of any of the fields in this section changes it will also need to be re-entered. In 1871 it was called the Local Board of Commissioners and in 1881 and 1891 it was called the Urban or Rural Sanitary District. If the information has not been recorded enter a – (hyphen) at the start of each ED.

Field name **location_flag**

Column Contains ED Query Flag

Year/s Used All censuses

What Can Be Entered x or X or blank

Description and Rules If the Transcriber or Proofreader has doubts about an ED entry being 'as is' they should enter a flag here.

Household Information

Field name **folio_number**

Column Contains Folio Number

Year/s Used 1841 – 1901

What Can Be Entered Number

Description and Rules Only enter this number each time that it changes. If a Folio Number is missing from its normal position DO NOT type zero. Leave it out unless you can work it out from the page numbers.

Field name **page_number**

Column Contains Page number

Year/s Used 1841 - 1901

What Can Be Entered Number

Description and Rules Only enter this number each time that it changes.

Field name **schedule_number**

Column Contains Schedule number

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Number and a suffix

Description and Rules Please refer to Handbook.

Field name **uninhabited_flag**

Column Contains Unoccupied

Year/s Used 1841 - 1901

What Can Be Entered u, b, n, v or blank

Description and Rules This is used where a schedule has no family attached to it: Where the enumerator has not entered a schedule number, enter a schedule number of 0 (zero). Please refer to Handbook for more deatils.

Field name **house_number**

Column Contains House Number

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Number or number plus suffix or fraction or blank

Description and Rules Only enter this once for each schedule and on the same row as the schedule number. If no house number has been recorded leave this field blank. See Handbook for detailed information.

Field name **house_or_street_name**

Column Contains Address

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Broad Text or blank

Description and Rules Only enter this information once for each schedule and on the same row as the schedule number. If there is no address recorded leave this field blank.

Field name **rooms**

Column Contains No. Rooms

Year/s Used 1901 and 1911

What Can Be Entered Number or blank

Description and Rules Only enter this once for each schedule on the same row as the schedule number. If there is nothing recorded leave it blank.

Field name **address_flag**

Column Contains Address Query

Year/s Used All censuses

What Can Be Entered x or X or blank

Description and Rules If the Transcriber or Proofreader has doubts about a household entry being 'as is' they should enter a flag here.

Individual Information

Field name **surname**

Column Contains Surname

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Broad Text

Description and Rules Enter this for each person in the family. It should be entered 'as is' even if it is known to be wrong. Enter a - (hyphen) if no surname is enumerated. See Handbook for detailed information.

Field name **forenames**

Column Contains Forenames

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Broad Text

Description and Rules Enter this for each person in the family. Forenames should be entered 'as is' even if they are known to be wrong. Enter a – (hyphen) if no forename is enumerated. Infant is an acceptable forename. See Handbook for detailed information.

Field name **name_flag**

Column Contains Name Query

Year/s Used All censuses

What Can Be Entered x or X or blank

Description and Rules If the Transcriber or Proofreader has doubts about a name entry being 'as is' they should enter a flag here.

Field name **relationship**

Column Contains Relationship

Year/s Used 1851 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text or blank

Description and Rules Enter the relationship to the head in full in this column. Where no relationship is recorded leave the field blank. Do NOT make assumptions.

Field name **marital_status**

Column Contains Marital Status

Year/s Used 1851 - 1911

What Can Be Entered m, s, u, w, d, - or blank

Description and Rules Enter a single letter m, s, u, w or d (Married, Single, Unmarried, Widowed or Divorced) or blank.

Field name **sex**

Column Contains Sex

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered m, f or -

Description and Rules If the age columns are empty, then enter - (hyphen). Do not make assumptions. A blank is not an acceptable entry.

Field name **age**

Column Contains Age

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Up to three numerals and one letter (y, m, w or d) or Complex age (see Handbook)

Description and Rules You MUST enter a number for each person. Zero is not acceptable. If the age is blank then enter 999 **without entering** a query flag *(Enter 999 not 999y)*. Standard Rules for Age are listed in the Handbook.

Field name **years_married**

Column Contains Years Married

Year/s Used 1911

What Can Be Entered Number or Complex number or blank

Description and Rules Enter the value as shown in the census. Enter it only once for each married couple next to the female member of the family, usually enumerated as wife. Where no information is recorded leave the field blank. Standard Rules for Years Married are listed in the Handbook.

Field name **children_born_alive**
Column Contains Children Born Alive
Year/s Used 1911
What Can Be Entered Number or blank
Description and Rules The value should appear next to a female member of the family, usually enumerated as wife.

Field name **children_living**
Column Contains No. Living
Year/s Used 1911
What Can Be Entered Number or blank
Description and Rules The value should appear next to a female member of the family

Field name **children_deceased**
Column Contains No. Deceased
Year/s Used 1911
What Can Be Entered Number or blank
Description and Rules The value should appear next to a female member of the family, usually enumerated as wife.

Field name **individual_flag**
Column Contains Individual Query
Year/s Used All censuses
What Can Be Entered x or X or blank
Description and Rules If the Transcriber or Proofreader has doubts about any of the individual information being ‘as is’ they should enter a flag here.

Employment Information

Field name **occupation**
Column Contains Occupation
Year/s Used All censuses
What Can Be Entered Broad Text or blank
Description and Rules Transcribe the occupation exactly as enumerated in the census. Do not correct spellings. In 1841 there were standard abbreviations for particular occupations. These abbreviations should be expanded to their full meanings. A table of 1841 abbreviations can be found in the Handbook.

Field name **industry**
Column Contains Industry
Year/s Used 1911
What Can Be Entered Broad Text or blank
Description and Rules Transcribe the industry exactly as shown in the census. This information was often left blank.

Field name **occupation_category**
Column Contains Employment Status
Year/s Used 1891 – 1911
What Can Be Entered e, r, n or blank
Description and Rules 1891 enter r for "employeR"; e for "employeE"; n only when marked as "Not employer/employee". If a person is marked for both "employeR" and "employeE" enter r. 1901 the census changes to Employer, Worker or Own Account. Enter r for EmployeR; e for Worker; and n for Own Account.

Field name **at_home**
Column Contains At Home
Year/s Used 1901 – 1911
What Can Be Entered h or blank
Description and Rules Enter an h in this column. Where no information is recorded leave the field blank.

Field name **occupation_flag**
Column Contains Occupation Query
Year/s Used all censuses
What Can Be Entered x or X or blank
Description and Rules If the Transcriber or Proofreader has doubts about any of the occupation information being ‘as is’ they should enter a flag here.

Birth Information

Field name **verbatim_birth_County**
Column Contains Chapman Code (CHP)
Year/s Used All censuses
What Can Be Entered Valid Chapman Code
Description and Rules Enter the County as a Chapman Code

Field name **verbatim_birth_place**

Column Contains POB

Year/s Used 1851 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Broad Text or – (hyphen)

Description and Rules Enter the Place of Birth that is written on the Census Page including any misspellings. If you believe it to be incorrectly spelt or the County to be incorrect you can enter your suggestion in the birth_County and birth_place columns *(Note: both columns must be completed*. *There is no need to enter a flag).* Sometimes a place of birth is entered as a smaller place followed or preceded by the name of a larger nearby place. **Always** show the name of the larger place first. It is extremely important that you follow the larger to smaller rule. '- cannot be entered as a hyphen. A - must be used. See Handbook for detailed information.

Field name **nationality**

Column Contains Nationality Details

Year/s Used 1851 – 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text or blank

Description and Rules Information such as 'Naturalised' or 'British Subject' is entered here. Enter the information 'as is'. Where no information is recorded leave the field blank. From 1851 to 1901 notes such as 'British Subject' were added to the census by the enumerator, usually in the margin. Enter these notes in this column.

Field name **birth_county**

Column Contains Alternative Chapman Code

Year/s Used 1841 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Valid Chapman Code or blank

Description and Rules The Transcriber and / or Proofreader and / or the Validator can put their own choice of Chapman Code in this column. A table of Chapman Codes can be found in the Handbook.

Field name **birth_place**

Column Contains Alternative Place of Birth

Year/s Used 1851 - 1911

What Can Be Entered Narrow Text or hyphen (-) or blank

Description and Rules The Transcriber and / or Proofreader and / or the Validator can put their own choice of Place of Birth in this

column. Follow the larger to smaller guideline. ‘- cannot be entered as a hyphen.

Field name **place_birth_flag**
Column Contains POB Query
Year/s Used all censuses
What Can Be Entered x or X or blank
Description and Rules If the Transcriber or Proofreader has doubts about any of the place of birth information being ‘as is’ they should enter a flag here. Do not enter a flag if you have entered an alternative in the birth_county and birth_place columns. It will automatically be displayed at Validation.

Miscellaneous Information

Field name **disability**
Column Contains Disability
Year/s Used 1851 - 1911
What Can Be Entered Broad Text or blank
Description and Rules Enter the disability as enumerated. Where no information is recorded leave the field blank.

Field name **disability_notes**
Column Contains Disability Notes
Year/s Used 1911 only
What Can Be Entered Broad Text or blank
Description and Rules Enter the information as enumerated. Where no information is recorded leave the field blank.

Field name **language**
Column Contains Language
Year/s Used Wales 1891 – 1911 and Isle of Man
What Can Be Entered Up to 2 letters or blank
Description and Rules Enter the appropriate letter or letters for the language spoken here. Leave this entry blank if it has not been filled in on the census. Use a code from the list below:

E	English	M	Manx
G	Gaelic	ME	Manx and English
GE	Gaelic and English	W	Welsh
I	Irish	WE	Welsh and English
IE	Irish and English		

If you are using the England and Wales spreadsheet for a County that is not in Wales or the Isle of Man leave this column blank.

Notes

Field name	**notes**
Column Contains	Notes
Year/s Used	1841 - 1911
What Can Be Entered	Broad Text or blank

Description and Rules Enter any messages that you need to explain a query flag here. This is the only text field in which a / can be used, so that entries such as 1/2 can be made. This is the only text field in which a ? can be used

Testing a Spreadsheet

1. Select ‘CSV Batches’ from ‘Your Actions’
2. Select Upload New File
3. Select Choose file and locate the File on your computer.
4. Select the type of report
5. Select Upload

You will receive a report by email.

See Handbook for more detail.

If you have previously tested the same Spreadsheet you must Reload it. See Handbook for details.

A Transcription will be ready to hand to your Coordinator when it has been tested and all Error Reports have been resolved.